

SUPER-CYCLE READINESS REPORT 2026

Are American cities operationally prepared to coordinate multiple simultaneous SEAR-1 events — and what does the absence of that preparation cost?

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KEY FINDINGS AT A GLANCE

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Major U.S. host cities with formal Super-Cycle coordination doctrine as of publication

~90

Days before first SEAR-1 Super-Cycle event
— FIFA World Cup, June 2026

\$18B+

California economic exposure across three concurrent events, 2026-2028

INITIAL FINDINGS

No American City Is Prepared for What Is Already Underway

The United States is entering an era of compounded urban stress that existing emergency coordination infrastructure was not designed to handle. The convergence of multiple SEAR-1 events into overlapping windows — a **Super-Cycle** — represents a structural governance failure not yet named, measured, or addressed at the federal, state, or city level.

OUR RESEARCH BEGAN

with a straightforward question: what happens to a city's coordination infrastructure when two or more SEAR-1 events demand simultaneous response? The answer is not theoretical. It is operational. As of March 2026: **nothing structured happens — because no structure exists.**

Every major coordination framework deployed across U.S. cities was designed for a single event, a single agency lead, and a sequential response timeline. ICS, NIMS, and all derivative systems assume one incident command. None are architected for the overlap condition.

The Los Angeles region will host FIFA World Cup 2026, Super Bowl LXI (2027), and the Olympic Games LA28 — three consecutive SEAR-1 events under a single host committee (LASEC) across a 36-month window. **No unified coordination layer exists as of this publication.**

The primary gap is **doctrinal, not technological**. The absence of a shared vocabulary, multi-agency decision authority framework, and common data layer represents a governance failure. Technology cannot be effective without the foundational doctrine that currently does not exist.

HIGHLIGHTS

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cities have formal **Super-Cycle coordination doctrine** in place.

~90

days until FIFA 2026. First Super-Cycle event opens **without a unified coordination layer**.

8x

coordination overhead at three concurrent SEAR-1 events — **non-linear failure risk onset**.

“The stress of a Super-Cycle is not additive. It is multiplicative. Each concurrent event exponentially amplifies the coordination burden of every other.”

HAYES & BAYLOR · PROGRAM CONVERGE · INITIAL FINDINGS, MARCH 2026

The Stress of a Super-Cycle Is Not Additive. It Is Multiplicative.

Throughout the history of national security and urban resilience, large forces of compounded stress have reshaped the way cities think about coordination infrastructure. The introduction of ICS and NIMS redefined how agencies coordinated single events. The post-9/11 era opened multi-agency frameworks. Today, the convergence of major global events onto single host cities — what this report formally classifies as a **Super-Cycle** — is proving to be the next transformative stress condition. For U.S. cities hosting multiple SEAR-1 events simultaneously, this shift presents both a catastrophic risk and a structural opportunity.

A Super-Cycle is not only an operational scenario to manage — it is a catalyst for rethinking coordination infrastructure at its core. Emergency managers must now consider how doctrine, technology, and decision authority must be fundamentally redesigned for the overlap condition — not just the individual event.

This means coordination frameworks must now move beyond managing individual events toward building persistent multi-agency operational intelligence layers. The enduring challenge remains: how do cities ensure their people, platforms, and doctrine are ready for what's next?

We hope this initial findings brief from Program Converge serves as a valuable resource for the emergency managers, federal coordinators, and city operational leads who will make the decisions that determine whether the 2026-2028 Super-Cycle becomes a model of coordinated resilience — or a lesson in what happens when doctrine fails to keep pace with operational reality.

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No existing platform was built for the overlap. The clock is running.

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■ ABOUT THIS REPORT

Program Converge
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SECTION 02

Defining the Super-Cycle

A formal operational classification for a condition that has existed in practice — but never in doctrine. Naming the problem is the first step toward solving it.

FORMAL DEFINITION

Super-Cycle (operational classification) — The compressed, compounded operational impact produced when two or more SEAR-rated events converge on a single city simultaneously. Unlike additive stress, Super-Cycle stress is multiplicative: each additional concurrent event exponentially amplifies resource conflict, decision authority disputes, and coordination failure risk across all participating agencies.

1x Baseline: single SEAR-1 event coordination overhead	~3x Overhead when a second concurrent event is added — compounding begins	8x+ Three concurrent SEAR-1 events. Non-linear onset. Super-Cycle threshold.
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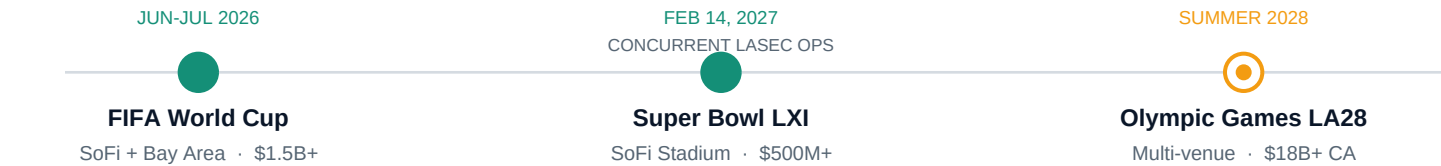
The SEAR classification system — Special Event Assessment Rating — provides federal guidance for events requiring coordinated multi-agency response. SEAR-1 designates the highest complexity tier: events requiring full federal coordination, including the Olympics, Super Bowl, and presidential inaugurations. The system was designed to classify individual events. It was *not* designed for overlap.

SECTION 03

The California Window

Three SEAR-1 events. One city. Thirty-six months. No coordination platform. The clock reached its first critical moment before this report was published.

~90 Days until FIFA World Cup 2026 opens in Los Angeles FIFA / USSF SCHEDULE	\$18B+ Projected California economic impact across all three concurrent events GOVERNOR'S OFFICE · LAEDC	15M+ Expected spectators for Olympic Games LA28 alone LA28 ORGANIZING COMMITTEE
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“LASEC is managing the buildup of a World Cup simultaneously with Super Bowl preparation — while a third event at greater scale is being constructed in parallel. This is not a hypothetical stress test. This is the operational reality of the next 90 days.

BAYLOR, D. · SECURITY INTELLIGENCE ASSESSMENT · PROGRAM CONVERGE, Q1 2026

SECTION 04

Current Readiness Assessment

Six coordination dimensions evaluated against Super-Cycle requirements. Each reflects current capability as of March 2026.

DIMENSION	SUPER-CYCLE REQUIREMENT	CURRENT CAPABILITY	STATUS
Multi-Agency Data Layer	Shared real-time operational picture across 9+ concurrent agencies	Agencies operate on isolated, siloed systems — no cross-agency data layer in any U.S. host city	NOT MET
Cross-Event Authority Chain	Pre-defined decision rights spanning simultaneous event types	Single-event ICS structures — no defined protocol for concurrent SEAR-1 authority overlap	NOT MET
Unified Coordination Layer	Role-scoped shared dashboard for all participating agencies	Ad hoc — email, phone, manual coordination. No unified operational interface deployed	NOT MET
Early Warning Integration	Federal intelligence to city layer in seconds	Manual NIMS notification pathways — minutes to hours latency from alert to acknowledgment	PARTIAL
Evidence Ledger / Auditability	Immutable real-time record for FEMA compliance	Post-event documentation only. No real-time decision record in any active deployment	PARTIAL
Readiness Certification (SCCE)	Standardized readiness threshold before live event deployment	No formal readiness certification framework exists for Super-Cycle scenarios	NOT MET

SECTION 05

The Path Forward

Five actions in sequence. Doctrine precedes technology. The critical path begins with naming the problem — which this report initiates.

ACTION 01 · Q1 2026

Establish Shared Doctrine

Develop and publish a formal operational Super-Cycle definition with agreed SEAR classification standards, multi-agency decision authority frameworks, and coordination protocols. Must be co-authored by federal, state, and city domain operators. This report is the first step of that process.

ACTION 02 · PRE-FIFA 2026

Deploy a Multi-Agency Data Layer

Implement an open data coordination model: agencies contribute operational data and read across a shared layer under defined access controls. Agency-scoped write, cross-agency read. The model must operate without a single controlling organization.

ACTION 03 · Q2-Q3 2026

Validate Under Simulated Conditions

SEAR Game exercises — multi-agency simulations run against realistic Super-Cycle scenarios. SEAR Game 1: Atlanta (GEMA co-sponsored). SEAR Game 2: California scenario, Q3 2026. After-action reports feed the next research publication.

ACTION 04 · ONGOING

Certify Cities to a Minimum Readiness Standard

Establish and enforce the SCCE threshold that cities must achieve before full coordination stack deployment. Certification renews annually and is enforced at the platform access layer.

ACTION 05 · ECOSYSTEM

Anchor to a Self-Sustaining Ecosystem

Program Converge is the research and validation layer that gives CiviGrid its institutional credibility — academic research partners, corporate co-investors, and strategic government operators working at scale.

The clock is running. What happens next is a choice.

This report was written for the people who will make that choice — emergency managers, city operational leads, federal coordinators, and large-scale event security professionals. Program Converge is actively seeking participation from qualified operators.

Domain Validators

SCAP-AO Advisory Operators with federal or state operational authority.
Your experience validates the doctrine.

Research Co-Authors

Domain experts contributing to the Super-Cycle White Paper.
Co-authorship requires domain credentials — not Sentrais affiliation.

SEAR Game Co-Sponsors

Agencies willing to co-host Atlanta or California scenario exercises.
Operational co-sponsorship gives exercises institutional weight.

City Operational Leads

Atlanta and Los Angeles municipal emergency management leaders.
Active engagements in progress in both cities.